AI Innovation Competition Judging Rubric

Project: _____ **Team:** _____ **Judge:** _____ **Track:** _____

How to score. Score each of the seven categories from 1 to 4. Choose the level that best matches what the team **demonstrated**; do not give credit for features that were only described or planned (future potential is assessed under Impact). Score each category independently. Seven equally weighted categories total 28 points.

Category	1 — Beginning	2 — Developing	3 — Proficient	4 — Exemplary	Score
Innovation and Creativity *originality of the idea*	Familiar idea with little adaptation or originality.	Known idea with modest adaptation or applied to a new context.	Fresh approach to an existing problem, or a thoughtful new use of technology.	Idea is innovative, original, and demonstrates outside-the-box thinking in addressing the problem.	____ / 4
Technical Execution *quality of the build, not difficulty alone*	Components are poorly connected or the approach does not suit the problem.	Basic implementation; components work together but with notable gaps in soundness.	Sound implementation; tools, AI capabilities, or integrations combined effectively with appropriate challenge.	Well-engineered answer to a substantial technical challenge; the approach clearly fits the problem.	____ / 4
Use of AI and Responsible Design	AI is unnecessary or its role is unclear; no attention to risks.	AI adds some value; alternatives not considered and risks mentioned only briefly.	AI clearly adds value over a simpler approach; main risks (errors, bias, privacy) identified with a basic mitigation.	AI is essential to the solution; key risks tested or mitigated, with human oversight where appropriate.	____ / 4
Completeness *what works, and honesty about what does not*	Core features missing or not working; the solution cannot be demonstrated.	Some core features work; significant gaps or bugs.	Main function works; some features unfinished or minor issues.	All core features work reliably as demonstrated; limitations are stated clearly and honestly.	____ / 4
Design and Usability	Interface or workflow is confusing and hard to use.	Usable with effort; inconsistent or unclear in places.	Visually clear and generally easy to navigate; some areas need refinement.	Intuitive, visually cohesive, and designed for its intended users, with accessibility considered.	____ / 4
Impact	Problem, intended users, or practical value is unclear.	Problem is stated, but users or value are generic or assumed.	Clear problem, specific users, and a plausible benefit.	Meaningful problem supported by evidence of need or value, and a realistic path to real-world use.	____ / 4
Presentation *communication only*	Hard to follow; the demo provides little evidence.	Main points are understandable but disorganized, or the demo is partial.	Clearly explains the problem, solution, and approach; demo shows the core function.	Clear, organized, and convincing; effective demo; answers questions thoughtfully.	____ / 4

Total score _____ / 28

Strongest aspect: _____

Next improvement: _____